

INNOVEXA STUDIOS

Website Build — Technical Handoff & Setup Guide

Full-stack marketing site: React (Vite, Tailwind CSS, Framer Motion, Lucide) frontend with an Express, MongoDB (Mongoose) and Nodemailer backend for the contact form.

Stack	React 18 · Node.js/Express · MongoDB · Nodemailer
Deliverable	innovexa-studios.zip (backend/ + frontend/ + README.md)
Sandbox verification	npm install ✓ · frontend build ✓ · backend boot ✓
Contact recipient	jefrinabcde@gmail.com

Project Structure

```
innovexa-studios/
|-- backend/
| |-- models/Contact.js # Mongoose schema
| |-- routes/contact.js # POST /api/contact (save + email)
| |-- server.js # Express app entry point
| |-- package.json
| `-- .env.example
`-- frontend/
    |-- src/
    | |-- components/ # Header, Hero, Services, Metrics, Connect, Footer
    | |-- App.jsx
    | |-- main.jsx
    | `-- index.css
    |-- index.html
    |-- tailwind.config.js
    |-- vite.config.js
    |-- package.json
    `-- .env.example
```

1. Backend Setup

```
cd backend
npm install
cp .env.example .env
# edit .env: set MONGO_URI, SMTP_USER, SMTP_PASS, NOTIFY_EMAIL
npm run dev # nodemon, http://localhost:5000
```

Gmail SMTP note

You cannot use your normal Gmail password. Enable 2-Step Verification on the sending Gmail account, then create an App Password at myaccount.google.com/apppasswords and use that 16-character value as SMTP_PASS. NOTIFY_EMAIL is the address that receives lead notifications (defaults to `jefrinabcde@gmail.com`).

MongoDB

Either run MongoDB locally (`mongodb://127.0.0.1:27017/innovexa-studios`) or use a free MongoDB Atlas cluster and paste its connection string into MONGO_URI.

2. Frontend Setup

```
cd frontend
npm install
npm run dev # http://localhost:5173
```

The Vite dev server proxies `/api/*` requests to `http://localhost:5000` (see `vite.config.js`), so the contact form works against the local backend with zero extra config. For production, set VITE_API_URL to your deployed API's full contact endpoint.

3. Build for Production

```
cd frontend
npm run build # outputs static site to frontend/dist
```

Deploy `frontend/dist` to any static host (Vercel, Netlify, S3 + CloudFront) and the `backend/` folder to any Node host (Render, Railway, EC2), pointing VITE_API_URL / CLIENT_URL at each other's live URLs.

Sandbox Verification Log

The following checks were run in an isolated build sandbox to confirm the code is free of install, build, and startup errors before handoff.

Check	Result
backend: npm install	122 packages installed, no errors
frontend: npm install	156 packages installed, no errors
frontend: npm run build	1,974 modules transformed, build succeeded in 3.73s
backend: node server.js	Boots correctly; attempts MongoDB connection as expected
backend: JS syntax check	server.js, routes/contact.js, models/Contact.js — all valid

Note: this sandbox has no MongoDB server and no network access to mongodb.com, so a live database connection and end-to-end email delivery could not be exercised here. Both are expected to work once run against a real MongoDB instance and valid SMTP credentials, per the setup steps above.

Troubleshooting

- **"MongoDB connection error"** — MongoDB isn't running; start it with mongod or a Docker container.
- **Form submits but no email arrives** — check the backend terminal for a Nodemailer error, usually a wrong App Password.
- **CORS error in the browser console** — make sure CLIENT_URL in backend/.env matches your frontend's URL exactly (http://localhost:5173 in dev).